

Kansas Wildland Fire Management

The Adjutant General's Department
Office of the State Fire Marshal

A three-story stone building with a light-colored, textured facade. The building features arched windows on the second floor and a central arched entrance on the ground floor. The roof is dark with white trim around the eaves. The building is surrounded by lush green grass and yellow wildflowers in the foreground. A large, dark green tree is visible on the right side of the building. The sky is clear and blue.

County Responsibilities

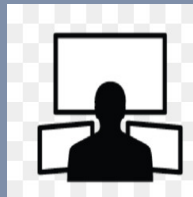
County Responsibility



The impacted county leads the emergency response efforts within their political jurisdiction.



A local incident commander is responsible for directing on-scene management and maintaining command and control of the incident operations.



County emergency management coordinates local emergency actions in support of incident management and requests outside assistance when necessary.

*State assistance
is available to
county
government
when the
following is met:*

1. Capability does not exist within the affected county or region;
2. County has exhausted all local resources within its jurisdictional boundaries;
3. County has exhausted all mutual aid pursuant to state law;
4. County has exhausted all contractor support; and
5. County has made verbal or written county declaration.

State Responsibilities



KSA 48, Article 9 – Emergency Preparedness for Disasters



48-905 Powers and duties to Adjutant General



48-911 Create mobile support units



48-914 Lease, sale or loan state property to federal or local governments



48-916 Authority to accept services, gifts, grants and loans



48-925 Power of the governor during a state of disaster emergency delegated to the Adjutant General



48-926 State disaster emergency plan; rules and regulations

KSA 48, Article 9 – Emergency Preparedness for Disasters



KSA 48-927 State resources plan



KSA 48-928 Duties of the Kansas Division of
Emergency Management (KDEM)



KSA 48-937 Communication systems during
disasters



KSA 48-952 Requests for assistance among
participating political subdivisions



KSA 48-9101 Emergency Management
Assistance Compact (EMAC)

31-143. Fire marshal authorized to advise and assist state civil defense director; assistance to municipalities; responsibilities and duties of state fire marshal.

- (a) The state fire marshal shall be authorized to advise, assist and coordinate with the state civil defense director in the development of civil defense or disaster plans, and on request shall assist any municipality in the enforcement of the state fire prevention code. He shall have the responsibility for the implementation of any fire safety programs developed by the state fire marshal and designed to minimize fire hazards and disasters in loss of life and property from these causes. Such responsibilities shall include, but are not limited to, the establishment and enforcement of fire safety practices throughout the state; preventive inspection and correction activities; coordination of fire safety programs with volunteer and paid fire companies, other state agencies and municipalities, and the state fire marshal shall analyze and evaluate Kansas fire loss statistics in order to make a determination of the problems.
- (b) The state fire marshal upon request shall assist the chief of any recognized fire company or department, any legally designated fire marshal of a municipality and the personnel of other state agencies in fire prevention matters.

*Office of
State Fire
Marshal KSA
75-1505*

Records of fires. The state fire marshal shall keep in his or her office a record of all fires occurring in the state, showing the name or names of the owners of personal and real property and the name or names of the occupants of buildings where fires occur, the total amount of insurance carried, the total amount of insurance collected, the total amount of loss to the property owner, together with all the facts, statistics and circumstances, including the origin of the fire, which may be determined by the investigation provided by this act.

*Kansas Forest
Service
KSA 76-
425(d)*

(g) provide assistance for the prevention and suppression of forest, brush or grassland fires in nonfederal areas of the state except on lands within the exterior boundaries of incorporated cities;

Kansas Response Plan

Kansas Response Plan



By the

Office of the Adjutant General
Division of Emergency Management
2800 Southwest Topeka Blvd
Topeka, Kansas 66611-1287
785-646-2001

Top 10 Kansas Hazards by ranking

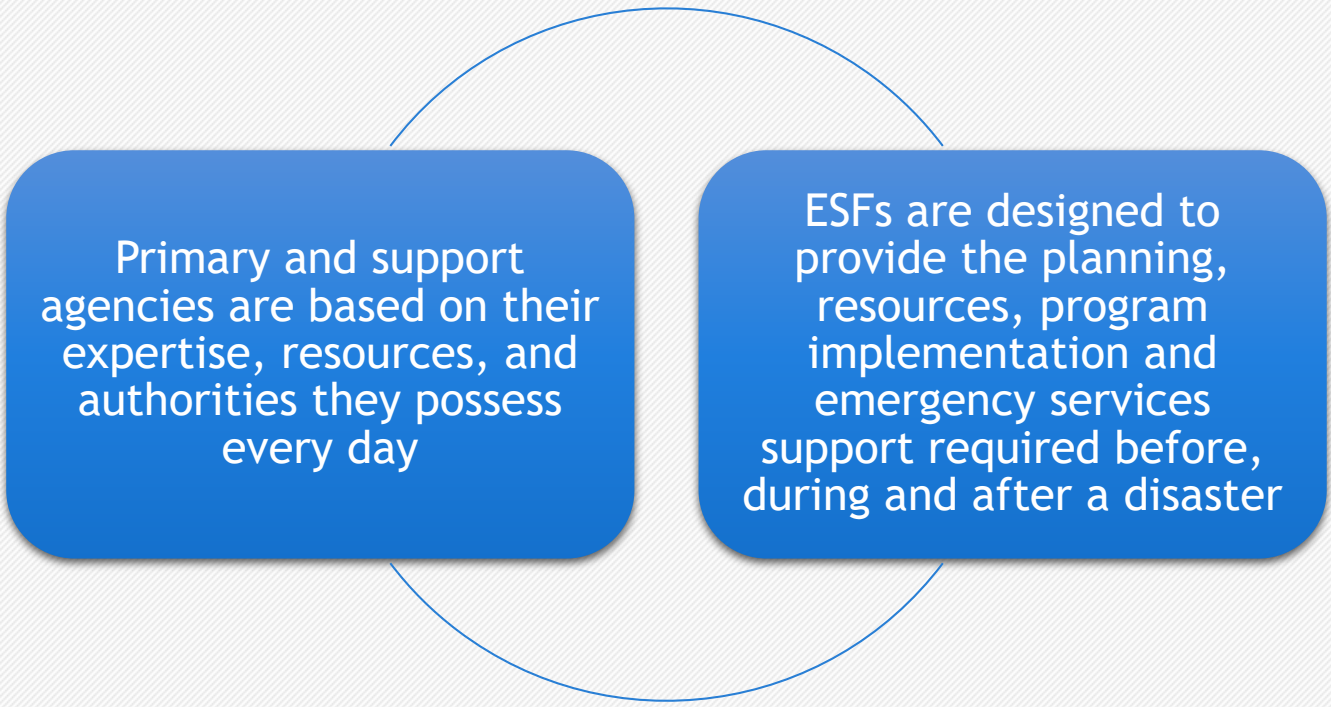
1. Flood
2. Tornado
3. Windstorm
4. Winter Storm
5. Wildfire
6. Agricultural Infestation
7. Hailstorm
8. Hazardous Materials
9. Utility/Infrastructure Failure
10. Drought



Kansas Response Plan

- Basic Plan
- Functional Annexes
- Incident Specific Annexes
 - Biological Incident
 - State Continuity of Government
 - Nuclear/Radiological Incident
 - Food and Agriculture Incident
- Support Annexes
 - Debris Management
 - Mass Casualty
 - Mass Fatality
 - Legal

Emergency Support Functions



Primary and support agencies are based on their expertise, resources, and authorities they possess every day

ESFs are designed to provide the planning, resources, program implementation and emergency services support required before, during and after a disaster

Emergency Support Functions (ESF)

- 1: Transportation
- 2: Communications
- 3: Public Works & Engineering
- 4: Firefighting
- 5: Information & Planning
- 6: Mass Care, Emergency Assistance, Temporary Housing & Human Services
- 7: Logistics Management & Resource Support
- 8: Public Health & Medical Services
- 9: Search & Rescue
- 10: Oil & Hazardous Materials Response
- 11: Agriculture & Natural Resources
- 12: Energy
- 13: Public Safety
- 14: Long term Community Recovery
- 15: External Affairs

ESF #4: Firefighting

Prevention, detection,
suppression and
recovery from urban,
rural, and wildland fires

- OSFM* (coordinator)
- KFS*

- KDHE
- KDOT
- KDWPT
- KSNG
- KDEM
- KHP



* Primary agency

ESF Notification



State Emergency Operations Center (SEOC) is activated and primary agencies are notified to report



The primary agency & KDEM determine which support agencies are required

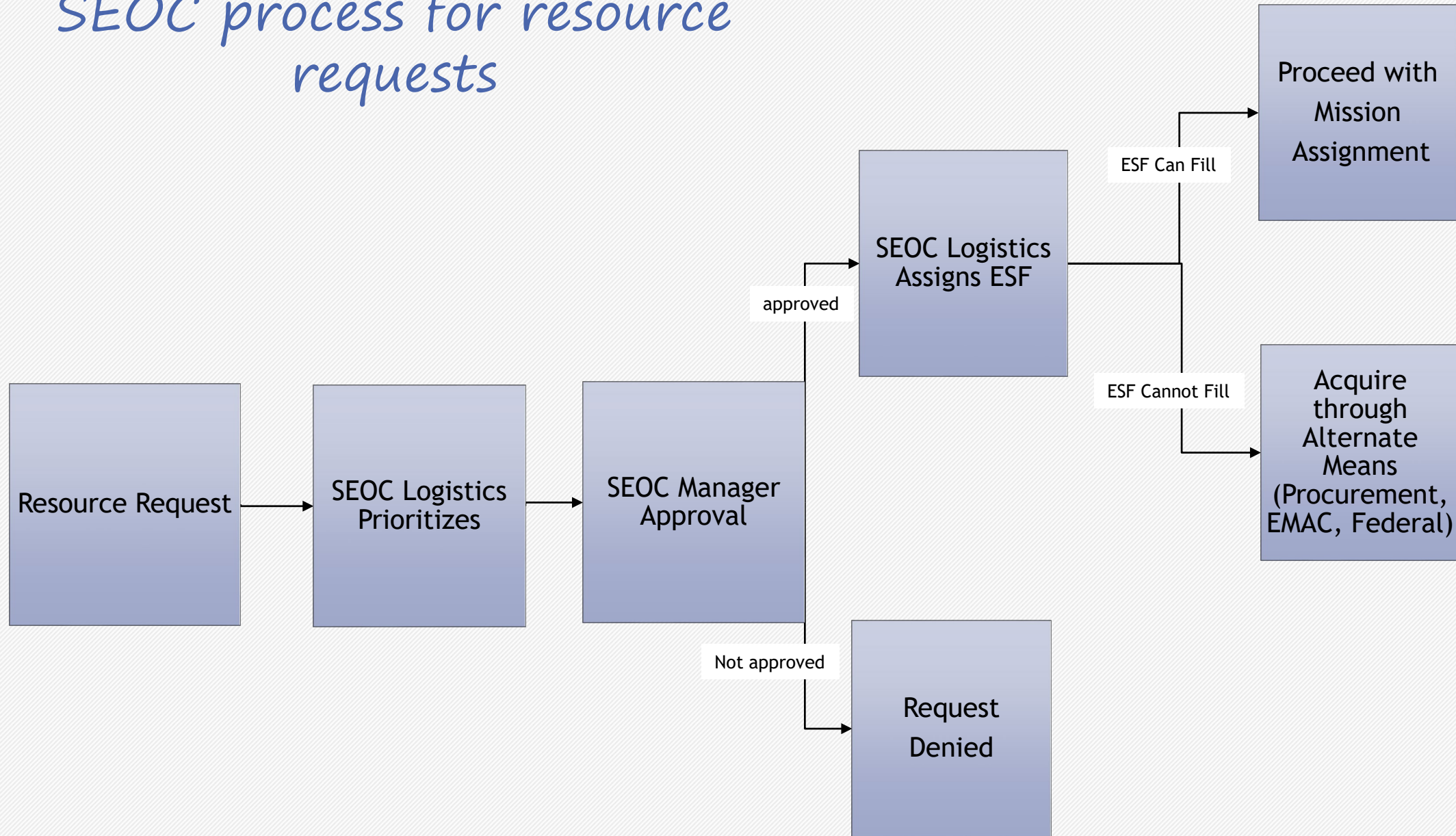


ESFs carry out and support one another



ESF provide the structure for coordinating interagency support for disaster preparedness, response and recovery

SEOC process for resource requests



Funding State disaster costs

When SEOC actions are taken without a federal disaster declaration, the costs incurred by state response efforts are paid for in two ways:

State agency
departmental budgets

State Disaster Fund
when response
activities fall outside a
statutory authority or
obligation of another
state agency.

State Disaster Costs Funding Methods

1

Adjutant General can request funds through the normal budget process, which is approved by the Kansas Legislature

2

Adjutant general can request action by the State Finance Council to release state general fund monies from the state emergency fund.

TAG requests funds from the State Finance Council only if the AGD does not have sufficient funds to pay estimated obligations and the Kansas Legislature is not in session. Amounts approved the State Finance Council are transferred from the state general fund to the state emergency fund, upon certification by the director of the budget.

Improvements

Increased Collaboration and Coordination



- Hosted 2018 and 2019 Wildland Fire Outlook Workshops
 - Reporting requirements
 - Resource Management
 - Statewide Comprehensive Resource Management & Credentialing System (CRMCS)
 - Requesting resources
 - Statewide mutual aid
 - Fire Management Assistance Grants (FMAGs)
 - Aerial firefighting resources
 - Climatology outlook
 - Great Plains Compact

Increased Collaboration and Coordination



Kansas Forest Service (KFS) designated as co-primary for ESF #4: Firefighting

Share information

Coordinate resources

Participate in all phases of emergency management process to include planning, exercises, and State Hazard Mitigation Team



KFS present in the State Emergency Operations Center (SEOC) during 2018 activations

Increased Collaboration & Coordination



Kansas National Guard (KSNG),
KFS, and OSFM developed a
wildland fire capability strategy

Increased Collaboration & Coordination

KDEM, KSNG, OSFM, National Weather Service (NWS) and KFS participated in Kansas Interagency Wildfire Council meetings and conference calls during heightened conditions

KDEM and KSNG maintained weekly readiness status of KSNG's aerial fire suppression assets and secured resources from State of Nebraska when there were gaps

Increased Collaboration & Coordination

KDEM added wildland fire danger outlooks to daily situation report to provide greater visibility to state and local emergency management stakeholders

KDEM activated SEOC during periods of increased fire danger

KDEM developed process for prioritization of aerial fire suppression

KDEM, OSFM and the Kansas Fire Working Group developed a process for facilitating mutual aid requests on behalf of local jurisdictions

Training

KDEM

- ✓ Conducted training on Fire Management Assistance Grant (FMAG)
- ✓ Requesting resources, reporting requirements, disaster declarations
- ✓ Statewide mutual aid
- ✓ WebEOC (state's virtual incident management software)
- ✓ Statewide Comprehensive Resource Management & Credentialing System (CRMCS)
- ✓ Position specific
- ✓ Incident Command System (ICS/Emergency Operations Center (EOC) Interface

Incident Management

- Commission on Emergency Planning & Response dissolved Incident Management Team (IMT) charter and moved it under the existing statutory authority of KDEM
 - Developed a strategic plan for recruitment, retention, training and exercises
 - Reviewed and updated procedures and policies to address gaps identified through after action reports and concerns from elected officials
 - Adopted the National All-Hazard IMT standards

Incident Management Support vs Emergency Operations Center (EOC) Support



KDEM conducted *Incident Command System (ICS)/EOC Interface* courses throughout the state



KDEM developed an EOC support team

Operational plan is in final stages and will begin recruitment and training soon

Resource Management

- The Kansas Fire Working Group adopted the statewide Comprehensive Resource Management and Credentialing System (CRMCS) as the only resource management system for the fire discipline
 - Implemented an aggressive campaign to encourage local fire departments to enter fire suppression equipment and personnel qualification into the system;
 - KDEM developed a process to facilitate mutual aid on behalf of locals and exercised with local fire departments;
 - Trained local fire chiefs on the use of the CRMCS and they are now mission assigned to report to the SEOC to facilitate local mutual aid;
 - Phone bank capacity was established

Resource Management

Kansas National Guard

- Purchased 5 additional BAMBI buckets - 9 total
- Purchased portable tanks to transport to rural areas where water is scarce
- Receiving 2 Type III wildland engines (AUG-SEPT 19)
- 59 guardsman trained to “Red Card” certification

OSFM

- Purchased 2 firefighting skid units that were installed on KSNG Humvees
- Purchased personal protective equipment for KSNG guardsmen

KDEM

- Purchased portable radios to be utilized to enable ground to air communications



Resource Management



The Kansas Fire Working Group developed typing definitions for wildland task force



Several regional task forces formed

Pre- Positioning of Resources

Aerial fire suppression resources, including KSNG Blackhawks were pre-positioned on critical fire danger days

Emergency Management Assistance Compact (EMAC) resources were used from Nebraska

Situational Awareness



- The NWS developed and have since released a satellite map that detects wildland fires minutes after they have started
 - NWS provided training to county emergency managers
 - NWS makes emergency notifications of detected wildland fire during real-time event

Recommendations

State General Funds/ Disaster Funds



Increase SGF to allow for prepositioning of resources during a governor's declaration of emergency;



Increase SGF to allow KDEM to provide additional support in training and exercises to local jurisdictions and additional SEOC staffing;



Increase SGF to KDEM to replace aging information technology capability and enhance SEOC operations;



Provide SGF to KFS for additional personnel to provide training to local firefighters

Education & Awareness



Continue to host an annual wildland fire outlook seminar



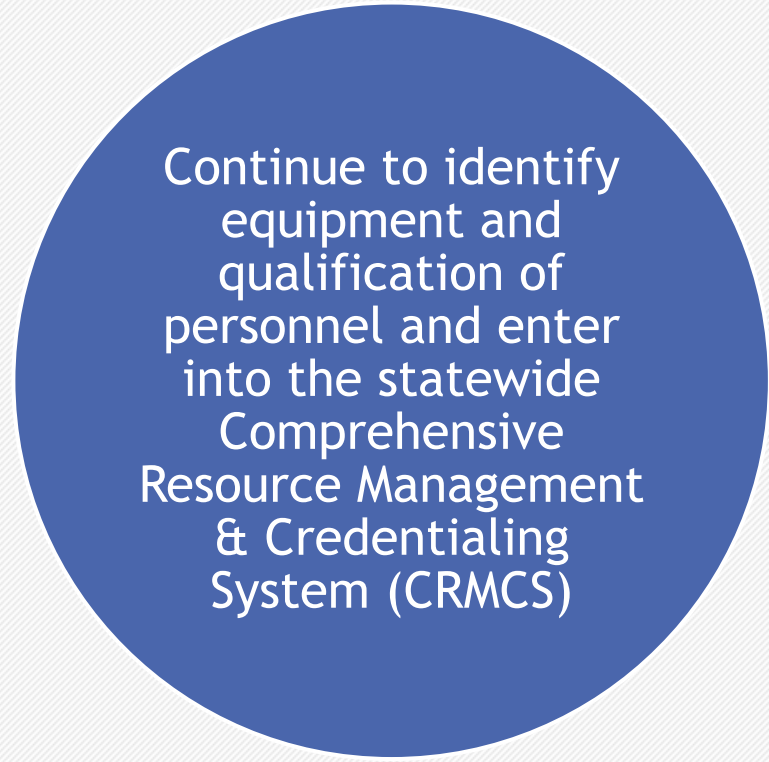
Encourage communities to become FireWise USA ©



Conduct wildland fire awareness campaign and encourage landowners, communities and the public to take mitigation efforts to lessen the threat of property loss and impact on the environment



Continue to provide training to county emergency managers and the fire service on statewide mutual aid, reporting requirements and requesting resources



Resource Management



Situational Awareness

Purchase GPS enabled cameras to be used by the Kansas Highway Patrol aerial assets to provide accurate, real time data to local incident commander



Questions /
Discussion